VINCENT BAGILET

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Current Position

Postdoctoral Fellow in Economics 2024 - Present
Ecole Normale Supérieure Lyon (ENS Lyon, CERGIC)

Education

PhD in Sustainable Development 2024
Columbia University

Master in Quantitative Economics (PPD) 2018
Paris School of Economics (PSE)

Master in Environmental Economics 2017
AgroParisTech - Paris-Saclay University

Master in Engineering, specialization in Energy 2017
Ecole Centrale Lyon, last year at Ecole Centrale Paris

Research Fields

Environmental Economics, Political Economy

Working Papers

Causal Exaggeration: Unconfounded but Inflated Causal Estimates [*Project website*, *Download*]

Abstract: The credibility revolution has made causal inference methods ubiquitous in economics. Yet there is widespread evidence of selection on statistical significance and associated biases in the literature. I show that these two phenomena interact to reduce the reliability of published estimates: while causal identification strategies alleviate bias from confounders, by restricting the variation used for identification they reduce statistical power and can exacerbate another bias–exaggeration. I characterize this confounding-exaggeration trade-off theoretically and through realistic Monte Carlo simulations, and explore its prevalence in the literature. In realistic settings, exaggeration can exceed the confounding bias these methods aim to eliminate. Finally, I propose practical solutions to navigate this trade-off, including a versatile tool to identify the variation and observations actually driving identification in applied causal studies.

Accurate Estimation of Small Effects: Illustration Through Air Pollution and Health
[*Project website*, *Download*]

Abstract: This paper identifies tangible design parameters that might lead to inaccurate estimates of relatively small effects. Low statistical power not only makes such effects difficult to detect but resulting published estimates also exaggerate true effect sizes. Through the literature on the short-term health effects of air pollution, we explore the prevalence of this issue, its implications for public policy and identify its drivers using real data simulations replicating prevailing identification strategies used in economics. We find that while some studies seem robust, others lead to substantial exaggeration. Simulations reveal five key drivers of exaggeration: sample size, effect magnitude, proportion of exogenous shocks, instrument strength, and outcome distribution. While the analysis builds on a specific literature, it draws out insights that expand beyond this setting. Finally, we discuss approaches to evaluate and avoid exaggeration when conducting a non-experimental study.

Work in progress

Climate Change Narratives: Environmental News in French Newscasts, *joint with Elisa Mougin*

Geopolitical Shocks and Environmental Discourse in Agriculture, *joint with Mathieu Couttenier, Sophie Hatte, and Elisa Mougin*

Peer Effects in Women's Political Participation, *joint with Jade Ponsard*

Research Experience

Visiting PhD student May – July 2023
Sciences Po, Economics Department, with *Emeric Henry*

Visiting PhD student June – August 2022
Toulouse School of Economics (TSE), with *Sylvain Chabé-Ferret*

Visiting PhD student June – July 2019
University of Oxford, INET, with *Linus Mattauch*

Research Intern in Environmental Economics April – Sept 2017
CIRED

Research Intern in Geopolitics of Resources April – June 2016
ENS Lyon, Michel Serres Institute

Research Intern in Development Economics January - April 2016
GATE Lyon

Research Intern in Political Economy May - Aug 2015
South African Institute of International Affairs

Teaching Experience

Current Teaching at ENS Lyon

Topics in Econometrics (Grad) — Fall 2024, 2025
Text As Data in Economics (Grad, course section) — Fall 2024, 2025
Introduction to Empirical Environmental Economics (Undergrad, half course) — Spring 2025, 2026
Data Visualization for Economics Research
(Lyon Summer School in Empirical Research Methods) — 2025, 2026

Past Teaching at ENS Lyon

Econometrics 1 (Grad, half course) — Fall 2024

Teaching Assistant at Columbia University

Environmental Science for Sustainable Development (PhD) — Fall 2021, 2022, 2023
Microeconomics and Policy Analysis II (Grad) — Spring 2022
Challenges of Sustainable Development (Undergrad) — Spring 2021
Macroeconometrics (Grad) — Spring 2020
Microeconomics and Policy Analysis I (Grad) — Fall 2019, 2020
Tutor: Microeconometrics, Macroeconometrics (Grad) — Fall 2019, Spring 2022

Fellowships and Grants

SIPA Dean's Fellowship, Columbia University — 2018-2024

Academic presentations

2025: *GATE on the Docs, EM Lyon - QUANT seminar, FAERE annual conference*

2024: *ENS de Lyon, Institut des Politiques Publiques*

2023: *TSE Environmental Economics Workshop*

2022: *EuHEA Conference*, TSE Environmental Economics Workshop*

2021: *Interdisciplinary Ph.D. Workshop in Sustainable Development, FAERE annual conference**

* = co-author

Service

Scientific Event Organization

CERGIC External seminars (co-organizer) 2024 - Present
Lyon Replication Games (local organizer) 2025
Interdisciplinary PhD Workshop on Sustainable Development (main organizer) 2021
Alliance Summer School in Sustainable Development (co-organizer) 2019

Referee

Economics of Transition and Institutional Change

Master Thesis Supervision

Clarisse Benoit Tondu, Arthur Dornat (co-supervision), Alexandra Ecuyer 2025-2026
Mateo Bortoli, Youenn Mandon (co-supervision) 2024-2025

Development of coding packages (in R)

ididvar: provides tools to identify the identifying variation in a regression
rallicagram: a wrapper to make simple and quick analyses of various text corpora
mediocrethemes: ready to use ggplot themes

Other information

Languages: French (*native*), English (*fluent*), Spanish (*conversational*)

Software skills: R , LaTeX , Python , Stata , Git , Matlab

Citizenship: French